

KARUNA KETAN

Game Designer

📍 Tamil Nadu, India | 📞 +91 7764870529 | ✉ gamesbykarunaket@gmail.com

in linkedin.com/in/karunaket | 📁 PORTFOLIO - karunaket.github.io/karunaketan

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Game Designer specializing in **Player Psychology**, **System Design**, **Level Design**, and **Economy Balancing**. Experienced in **rapid prototyping** and translating creative pillars into actionable **Game Design Documents (GDDs)**. Proven ability to design compelling **gameplay loops**, **spatial layouts**, and **progression systems** that consistently drive **player engagement** and **retention**.

PROJECTS

AOA: Space Scrap Smugglers (4-Player Co-op)

Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

Contract Game Designer | FatCatPlay Game Studio | [Link](#)

PC (Steam)

- **System Design & GDDs:** Drafted and maintained structured **Game Design Documents** for a physics-driven space mining simulation, establishing core loops and aligning design with production constraints.
- **Systemic Co-op Mechanics:** Engineered **physics-based tool synergies** to simulate smuggling illegal cargo, including a shared cargo crate and Gravity Beam that forces **emergent team communication**.
- **Level Architecture:** Created **top-down level layouts** and structured early **graybox blockouts** for the Training Spoke to validate player navigation and **spatial metrics** in asteroid environments.
- **Onboarding & Affordances:** Designed textless onboarding sequences utilizing **diegetic visual cues** and **environmental affordances** to teach spaceship piloting and core mechanics organically.

Shattered Charms: Through The Veil (Action RPG)

Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

Game Designer & Developer | [Link](#)

Unreal Engine 5

- **Progression Systems:** Designed a "Charm Fusion" matrix replacing **passive skill trees**, heavily incentivizing player experimentation and **ability synergy** to master combat.
- **Economy Balancing:** Modeled a **3-tier resource economy** using **Microsoft Excel**, mathematically balancing drop rates to ensure players actively engaged with side content.

Eclipse of Fear (Survival Horror)

Jul 2025 – Aug 2025

Game Designer & Developer | [Link](#)

Unreal Engine 5

- **Pacing & Psychology:** Engineered a **dynamic pacing director** that scales enemy wave intensity based on **real-time player metrics**, ensuring distinct **emotional peaks and valleys**.
- **Diegetic UI:** Implemented a physical "Lives as Papers" health system, replacing screen UI with interactable in-game objects to elevate **narrative immersion** and tension.

EXPERIENCE

FatCatPlay Game Studio

Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

Contract Game Designer

- Prepared structured **Game Design Documents (GDDs)** and systems for **Space Scrap Smugglers**, and designed enemy archetypes for **MegaDrift** (showcased at **IGDC 2024 & 2025**).
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to design **physics-based mechanics** and **top-down level layouts**, heavily iterating on game-play flow and balance based on internal playtesting feedback.

Akiyam Solutions

Jan 2024 – Jul 2024

Game Design Intern

- **Pipeline Optimization:** Reduced design iteration loops by **20%** using **technical flowcharts** and **One-Page Feature Briefs** to align cross-functional teams and prevent misinterpretations.
- **Level Design:** Designed **level blockouts** and **spatial metrics**, significantly improving player navigation and tutorial pacing based on playtest data.

Game Development Club (College)

Jan 2024 – Sep 2025

President

- Mentored a **200+ member community**, delivering **10+ workshops** on **rapid prototyping**, **System Design**, and **Engine Tools**, guiding student teams to ship **5 playable prototypes**.

SKILLS & SOFTWARE

Design Competencies: System Design, Game Economy & Balancing, Level Design, Player Psychology, Mechanic Deconstruction, Rapid Prototyping, Documentation (GDD, TDD, LDD, Flowcharts).

Production & Data Tools: Microsoft Excel, Google Docs, Google Slides, Miro, Figma, Notion.

Version Control: Git, Perforce, Diversion.

Engines: Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints), Unity.

EDUCATION

B.E. Computer Science and Engineering

2022 – 2026

KPR Institute of Engineering & Technology

Tamil Nadu, India